

Wide angle shooting

Canon has unveiled the SX30 IS camera which features the world's first wide angle 35x zoom lens

Symbian^3 x 3

The mobile phone giant has announced three new smartphones, the E7, C6-01 and C7 which will be in the market by year's end

HTC Wildfire

Android weds Sense, yet again

HTC Wildfire can be thought of as HTC Desire's little brother. Anyone who has seen the HTC Desire will immediately recognise brushed metal trim around the extended glass section of the display. At the bottom, the trim takes on a curved look. The feel of Wildfire is pretty good, though it isn't exactly compact and will feel most at home in larger hands. Despite the seemingly unnecessary bulk, it doesn't make an unseemly bulge in ones pocket.

The 3.2-inch Wildfire runs on Android 2.1 and has a 5 MP camera. The display resolution is extremely poor – at 240 x 320 pixels – an archaic resolution that, (as far as we know), only Nokia persists with. With a pixel density of 125 pixels per inch,

the Wildfire's display looks pretty pixellated and there is a marked loss of fine detail in the text, menus and this is also visible in the home screens. The on-screen QWERTY keypad is pretty good despite its rather basic look. In portrait mode things look cramped, but thanks to good screen sensitivity typos were a rarity. The capacitive touch-screen as with all HTC phones was quite fluid.

Audio quality via earphones is good – good clarity, nice bass and pretty good volume levels. Video playback is snappy, although the display would benefit with a higher resolution and a better contrast ratio. Basically, some



of the darker colours blend, while shades of grey are missed – not exactly for the portable videophile would be a gross understatement. Call clarity is good per se, with a few reservations. We didn't have any serious issues in any of the zones, and even in zone three, distortion was minimum, with some continuous noise and an occasional loss of coherence but no dropped calls.

Priced at ₹16,590 (MRP), the Wildfire isn't cheap, but it's good value – Android, good touch-screen with decent hardware and good performance. If the lack lustre display resolution and contrast aren't deterrents for you, the Wildfire will satisfy.

Specifications

CPU: 528 MHz Qualcomm MSM 7225; Display: 3.2-inches, 240 x 320 pixels, 16 million colours; Camera: 5-megapixel; Battery: 1300 mAh; Weight: 118 grams

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Web site: www.htc.com/in

Price: ₹16,590

7.0
10

Features 7.5
Performance 7
Build Quality 7.5
Value for money 7.0

Specifications

Display: 2.6-inches, 2,56,000 colours, 240 x 320 pixels; Camera: 3.15 MP; Battery: 930 mAh

Contact

Sony Ericsson

Phone: 1800 111 800

Web site: www.sonyericsson.com

Price: ₹9,000

7.5
10

Features 6.5
Performance 7.5
Build Quality 8
Value for money 7.0

Sony Ericsson Zyló

Slick Walkman

For a detailed review, check out <http://bit.ly/boQmjD>

The Zyló is a simplistic, yet slick looking handset. The front is dominated by a 2.6-inch display, and the large, attention drawing chrome ring that serves as a joypad. The middle button doubles as the play/pause key within while in walkman mode. The call buttons are well placed, and sufficiently delineated. The slider mechanism is a strong plus. The number keypad looks pretty normal though its usability quotient is actually excellent. The keys have sufficient bevelling to be used without visual super-

vision and exude good, firm feedback.

The Zyló is a very satisfactory music player. The loud-speaker, owing to the slightly curved rear works fine even if the phone is laid on a table. Audio quality is pretty good, and the volume is quite loud. Plug in the supplied earphones, and prepare to be impressed further. Music flows pretty effortlessly, with good clarity and volume levels.

The camera offers very basic



settings, no exposure compensation or autofocus.

In zone one, we had no issues with dropped calls and voice clarity was good. In zone three, we had a problem with static on the line, when the number of

available antennas fluctuated between one and zero. There was a marked loss of clarity.

The MRP is ₹9,000, but we've spotted the Zyló selling at around ₹7,800 on the street. A fair price for what you get.